



ENG523

Mid-Term (Solved)

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

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Discourse Analysis

Q. Define the following Terms:

- ✚ **Critical Discourse:** An interdisciplinary approach to the study of language and communication that focuses on how language reproduces social inequalities, power relations, and ideologies.
- ✚ **Coherent discourse:** A text or communication that is logically connected, consistent, and easy to follow, with a clear meaning or message.
- ✚ **Situational Context:** The environment, circumstances, and social setting in which communication takes place, influencing the meaning and interpretation of language.
- ✚ **Reference discourse:** A term used in CDA to describe the dominant or standard language variety used in a particular context or community, often associated with power and prestige.
- ✚ **Conversation Analysis:** A methodology for studying social interactions, particularly conversations, to understand how people use language to create social order and meaning.
- ✚ **Discourse community:** A group of people who share a common language, values, and practices, often with a shared goal or interest, and who use language to construct and maintain their identity and relationships.
- ✚ **Race/racism:** Social constructs used to categorize people into groups based on physical characteristics, often leading to discrimination, prejudice, and inequality.
- ✚ **spoken discourse:** Language use in face-to-face interactions, such as conversations, meetings, and discussions.
- ✚ **Prejudice:** A preconceived negative judgment or attitude towards a person or group, often based on stereotypes or biases.
- ✚ **Expressive:** A type of language function that expresses the speaker's feelings, emotions, or attitudes.
- ✚ **Informative:** A type of language function that conveys information, knowledge, or facts.
- ✚ **Declarative:** A type of sentence that states a fact or opinion, often used to make assertions or declarations.
- ✚ **Narrative Discourse:** A type of language use that tells a story or recounts an event or experience.
- ✚ **Discourse analysis:** A broad field of study that examines language use in social contexts to understand how language creates meaning and constructs social relationships.

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- ✚ **Adjacency pair:** An adjacency pair is a unit of conversation that contains an exchange of one turn each by two speakers. The turns are functionally related to each other in such a fashion that the first turn requires a certain type or range of types of second turn.
- ✚ **Pragmatics:** Pragmatics is the study of meaning in relation to the context in which a person is speaking or writing. This includes social, situational and textual context. It also includes background knowledge context; that is, what people know about each other and about the world.
- ✚ **Discourse speech act:** A term used to describe the actions performed through language, such as making a request, giving an order, or offering an apology.
- ✚ **Speech community:** A group of people who share a common language or dialect, often with shared cultural and social norms.

Q. Five features write about religious by John Du Bois?

John Du Bois (1996) identified some of the features of Religious language:

- ✚ Use of rituals
- ✚ Archaic elements
- ✚ Euphemism and metaphor
- ✚ Semantic opacity
- ✚ Unusual fluency
- ✚ Magic words

Q. Defining speech community

Defining a speech community there are some factors that make easier to define a speech community other than just language. Those are social, geographical, cultural, political and ethnic factors, race, age and gender. Not all of speakers always be full members of particular speech communities. For example, is in the case of second language setting. For example, a speaker may participate, only to a certain degree, in the target speech community.

Q. Exchange context

An exchange is a sequence of discourse moves by at least two speakers that forms a topical (or sub topical unit). A minimal exchange comprises an initiating move plus a contribution by another speaker. There are two classes of exchanges; boundary exchanges and teaching exchanges (Sinclair and Coulthard, 1992, pg.25). Boundary exchanges contain two moves, framing and focusing moves. The only three

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principals of teaching exchanges described by Sinclair and Coulthard are informing, directing, and eliciting exchanges

Q. Differentiate between language ideologies and attitudes

Language ideologies and language attitudes are conceptual tools used to understand speakers' feelings and ideas about languages and linguistic forms. Both concepts recognize the importance of linguistic subjectivity in understanding language change, identity, and socioeconomic context. They share similarities in focusing on speakers' feelings and beliefs about language structure and use. However, they differ in their historical development, methodological approaches, and fields of concern. Language attitudes typically involve quantitative measurement of speakers' reactions, while language ideologies employ qualitative methods like ethnography, conversational analysis, and discourse analysis. Language ideologies emphasize how speakers' beliefs and feelings are shaped by their social experiences and political economic systems, and how their awareness of language forms and functions is crucial. Despite these differences, both concepts aim to understand speakers' perspectives on language and its role in shaping identity and society. By recognizing the complementary strengths of both approaches, researchers can gain a more comprehensive understanding of language and its complex role in human communication.

Q. What do discourse analysis study?

Discourse analysis studies the use of language in social contexts to understand how language constructs meaning, creates social relationships, and produces social and cultural realities. It examines how language is used to:

- ✚ Create and maintain social identities, power dynamics, and social structures.
- ✚ Construct and negotiate meaning in social interactions and texts.
- ✚ Produce and reproduce social and cultural norms, values, and beliefs.
- ✚ Create and challenge social inequalities, power relations, and ideologies.
- ✚ Shape and reflect social and cultural contexts, including historical and institutional contexts.

Q. Language forms/ language functions

A **language function** refers to what students do with language as they engage with content and interact with others. Functions represent the active use of language for a specific purpose.

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Language forms deal with the internal grammatical structure of words and phrases as well as the word them. Students use language functions in order to express ideas, communicate with others, and show understanding of content in an academic setting.

Q. Language and discourse relationship

Language and discourse have a deeply intertwined relationship. Discourse refers to the use of language in social contexts to create meaning and construct social relationships. Language, on the other hand, is the tool used to create discourse.

- ✚ Language is the medium for discourse: Discourse is constructed through language, using words, phrases, sentences, and other linguistic elements to convey meaning.
- ✚ Discourse shapes language: Discourse influences how language is used, what words and phrases are chosen, and how they are combined to create meaning.
- ✚ Language reflects discourse: Language use reflects the social, cultural, and historical context of discourse, including power dynamics, social roles, and cultural values.
- ✚ Discourse constructs social reality: Through language, discourse creates and maintains social reality, shaping our understanding of the world and our place within it.
- ✚ Language is a tool for discourse strategies: Discourse uses language strategically to achieve social goals, such as persuasion, negotiation, or identity construction.

Q. Talk in transaction

Talk is associated with other activities. For example, students may be engaged in hands-on activities (e.g., in a science lesson) to explore concepts associated with floating and sinking. In this type of spoken language students and teachers usually focus on meaning or on talking their way to understanding.” (Jones 1996:14)

Examples of talk as transaction are:

- ✚ Classroom group discussions and problem-solving activities
- ✚ A class activity during which students design a poster
- ✚ Discussing needed computer repairs with a technician
- ✚ Discussing sightseeing plans with a hotel clerk or tour guide
- ✚ Making a telephone call to obtain flight information

Q. Three aspects that explore linguistic context

- ✚ Deictic
- ✚ co-text and
- ✚ collocation

Q. Concept of discourse and language choice

Discourse and language choice is a variation of language when we interact with the other communities as explained by Holmes (2001) that the choice of language is being used in such as, with family, among friends, and in religious, educational and employment settings. Social factors such as who we are speaking to, the social context of the interaction, the topic, function and goal of the interaction, social distance between speakers, the formality of the setting or type of interaction and the status of each of the speakers are also important for accounting for the language choice that a person makes in these kinds of settings.

Q. Spoken language

Spoken language refers to the use of language in face-to-face interactions, such as conversations, discussions, and oral communication. It involves the production and reception of spoken words, sounds, and gestures to convey meaning and communicate with others. Some key features of spoken language include:

- ✚ Immediacy: Spoken language is immediate and spontaneous, with little time for planning or editing.
- ✚ Informality: Spoken language is often informal, with a focus on communication rather than precision or formality.
- ✚ Contextual dependence: Spoken language relies heavily on the context in which it is used, including nonverbal cues like body language and tone of voice.
- ✚ Turn-taking: Spoken language involves turn-taking, where speakers take turns producing and receiving language.
- ✚ Feedback: Spoken language allows for immediate feedback, with speakers able to respond and react to each other in real-time.

Q. Functions of Discourse Markers

- ✚ to mark a boundary in discourse (shift/partial shift in topic),
- ✚ to preface a response or a reaction,
- ✚ to serve as a filler or delaying tactic,
- ✚ to aid the speaker in holding the floor,

- ✚ to affect an interaction or sharing between speaker and hearer

Q. What is the main concern of discourse analysis?

The main concern of discourse analysis is to understand how language is used to create meaning and construct social reality. It focuses on how language is used to:

- ✚ Shape and maintain social relationships and power dynamics
- ✚ Construct and negotiate identities, roles, and social positions
- ✚ Produce and reproduce social and cultural norms, values, and beliefs
- ✚ Create and challenge dominant discourses and ideologies
- ✚ Reflect and shape social and cultural contexts, including historical and institutional contexts.

Q. What is the common function in academic writing OR What is the common function in oral language OR What is the difference in between common function in academic writing and oral language OR Five language functions

In **oral language** some common functions may include:

- ✚ Giving instructions
- ✚ Making requests
- ✚ Defending an argument

In **academic writing** we use a range of specific functions in order to communicate ideas clearly. These include:

- ✚ Describing processes
- ✚ Comparing or contrasting things or ideas
- ✚ Classifying objects or ideas

Q. Austin divides speech act into three different categories:

- ✚ **Locutionary act:** This is the act of saying something. It has a meaning and it creates an understandable utterance to convey or express.
- ✚ **Illocutionary act:** It is performed as an act of saying something or as an act of opposed to saying something. The illocutionary utterance has a certain force of it. It well well-versed with certain tones, attitudes, feelings, or emotions. There will be an intention of the speaker or others in illocutionary utterance. It is often used as a tone of warning in day today life.
- ✚ **Perlocutionary act** – It normally creates a sense of consequential effects on the audiences. The effects may be in the form of thoughts, imaginations,

feelings or emotions. The effect upon the addressee is the main character ship of perlocutionary utterances.

Q. Explain the term of situational context?

Situational context, or context of situation, refers to the environment, time and place, etc. in which the discourse occurs, and also the relationship between the participants. This theory is traditionally approached through the concept of register, which helps to clarify the interrelationship of language with context by handling it under three basic headings: field, tenor, and mode. Field of discourse refers to the ongoing activity. We may say field is the linguistic reflection of the purposive role of language user in the situation in which a text has occurred. Tenor refers to the kind of social relationship enacted in or by the discourse. The notion of tenor, therefore, highlights the way in which linguistic choices are affected not just by the topic or subject of communication but also by the kind of social relationship within which communication is taking place. Mode is the linguistic reflection of the relationship the language user has to medium of transmission. The principal distinction within mode is between those channels of communication that entail immediate contact and those that allow for deferred contact between participants.

Q. Relationship between discourse and context?

Discourse and context are closely related concepts in linguistics and discourse analysis. Discourse refers to the use of language in social contexts to create meaning and construct social relationships. It involves the production and interpretation of texts, talk, and other forms of language use. Context, on the other hand, refers to the social, cultural, and situational factors that influence the meaning and interpretation of discourse.

Q. Socio-cognitive approach to racism

Discourse Studies as a cross discipline emerged in all the humanities and social sciences 50 years ago in the USA and various European countries, but initially focused mostly on formal aspects of text and talk: text grammar, semantic coherence and narrative and argumentation structures. A more sociopolitical orientation, Critical Discourse Studies (CDS), focused on forms of discursive power abuse, was initiated only in the 1980s, but since then has become very popular, for instance in the study of political discourse, media discourse and phenomena such as racism and sexism. Most forms of CDS establish direct links between discourse structures and social structures. In a socio-cognitive approach this relation is mediated by cognitive

structures, the only way heterogeneous discourse structures and social structures can be theoretically linked, for instance, by personal mental models and socially shared knowledge, attitudes and ideologies. Hence, a critical study of discourse must be based on such a socio-cognitive theory in order to be able to describe and explain the discursive reproduction of social domination, as well as the resistance against this domination.

Q. The context of spoken discourse, the distinction between text and discourse, and their roles in understanding

It is useful in analyzing spoken (as well as written) discourse understanding to draw a three-way distinction between the dimensions of text, discourse and context. Text, discourse and context Text: the connected sequence of verbal signs and non-verbal signals in terms of which discourse is co-constructed by the participants in the act of communication. Discourse: the hierarchically structured, situated sequence of indexical, propositional, utterance and illocutionary acts carried out in pursuance of some communicative goal, as integrated within a given context. The context is subject to an ongoing process of construction and revision as the discourse unfolds. It is through the invocation of a relevant context (which is partly determined by the nature of the co-text at issue, as well as by its genre) that the hearer or reader is able to convert the connected sequence of textual cues that is text into discourse. (Extract (slightly amended) from Cornish, 2003:3).

Q. Turn-Taking

A turn is the time when a speaker is talking and turn-taking is the skill of knowing when to start and finish a turn in a conversation. It is an important organizational tool in spoken discourse. One way that speakers signal a finished turn is to drop the pitch or volume of their voice at the end of an utterance. The rules regarding turn taking in formal situations can differ markedly than between people who are speaking casually together.